Berkeley 香花名录 · Fragrant Flower Reference for Berkeley, CA

22 scented plants with bilingual (Chinese–English) names. Sorted by **bloom start (December → September)** for easy year-round reference.

- **Climate background**: Central Berkeley flats (near University Ave / Trader Joe's; not the Berkeley Hills) ≈ USDA 10a on the 2023 map, with 10b pockets nearby; the 2012 map showed 10a here. Warm-summer Mediterranean (Köppen Csb) with strong marine influence: cooler, foggier summers than the hills (frequent afternoon marine layer that can persist into evening), mild winters, rare frost, ~22–25" annual rain.
- **Scent rating**: ★–★★★★★ (intensity detectable at arm's length; generally reduced on foggy days).

| English name | Chinese name | Berkeley cultivation notes | Scent notes | Bloom period (scent months) | Asian cultural notes | |---|---|---|---|---|---| | Wintersweet (Chimonanthus praecox)



| 蜡梅 | Easy to grow: full sun to partial shade, excellent drainage (does not tolerate standing water around the roots), drought-tolerant once established; yellow-flowered types are far more fragrant than white-flowered ones[1] | ★★★★ Cold fragrance that intensifies as temperatures drop; the yellow types ('Aureus'/'苏雨仙' lineage) are intense, white-flowered types are very faint | Dec–Feb | The twelfth-month (腊月) flower deity of the traditional "Flower Calendar" (花历); long prized in Chinese literati culture for its "cold fragrance" (冷香) as a symbol of lofty, unworldly character; sometimes grouped with other fragrant classics, though the standard "Four Gentlemen" (花中四君子) are plum, orchid, bamboo and chrysanthemum | | Wallflower (Cheiranthus cheiri, now Erysimum × cheiri)



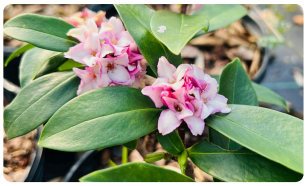
| 桂竹香[2] | Easy to grow: cool-season crop, grown as a biennial (short-lived perennial); full sun, does not tolerate standing water (well-drained soil); frequent deadheading prolongs the bloom | ★★★★ Spicy-sweet Brassicaceae scent - the old-fashioned "wall scent" (hence the English name wallflower) | Dec–Mar | In the Chinese tradition, in fine gardens by the Tang dynasty (recorded in ancient materia medica (《本草》) texts and in Tang poetry) - on that lineage, one of the oldest winter-fragrance flowers in the Chinese garden context | | White Champaca (Magnolia × alba)



| 白兰 | Tender subtropical hybrid: cold-sensitive and prefers warmer, more protected microclimates. In the cooler, foggier central Berkeley flats, in-ground flowering is unreliable and pot + winter protection is safer; established trees do flower well in warmer Bay Area spots (e.g. Berkeley Hills, SF Botanical Garden, Stanford) | ★★★★★ The reference scent of the street flower vendors and yulan tea; most intense in the cool morning | Dec–Mar (Bay Area); multiple flushes in warm regions | Core of Lingnan (South China) and old-Shanghai folk custom: flowers pinned in the hair, street flower carriers (花婆, "flower aunties"), yulan (白兰) tea; the Cantonese name "pak lan" is the Cantonese reading of 白兰, and the flower is a staple of Lingnan nostalgia imagery (the classic song 白兰花, literature); close relative Yellow Champaca (黄缅桂) (yellow champaca, *Magnolia champaca*) is an offering flower in South Asian Hindu and Buddhist worship | | Banana Shrub (Michelia figo, syn. Magnolia figo)



| 含笑 | Extremely easy: cold- and drought-tolerant, full sun to partial shade, almost maintenance-free | ★★★–★★★★ Banana-sweet fragrance, strongest in the morning and when cool | Primarily spring (Apr–Jun), with possible extension into summer/fall in mild Bay Area climates | "Manjushri's smile" from the Vimalakirti Sutra; the idiom "smile in the netherworld" derives from the flower; common subject in literati painting | | Winter Daphne (Daphne odora)



| 瑞香 | Very easy to grow (the least demanding of the *Daphne* genus): drainage is a matter of life and death (does not tolerate standing water around the roots), summer-dry, full sun to partial shade; performs even better in the Bay Area than in the East | ★★★★★ One of the most intense woody-plant scents of winter and spring | Jan–Mar (earlier in the Bay Area than in the East) | the name 瑞香 means "fragrance of auspicious omen" (花中祥瑞 "auspicious omen among flowers"); *Daphne* is planted in the 紫竹林 (Purple Bamboo Grove) on Mt. Putuo, a Guanyin/Avalokiteshvara pilgrimage site | Paperwhite Narcissus (Narcissus papyraceus / tazetta group)



| 洋水仙（纸白型）[3] | Primarily an indoor forcing bulb: set on pebbles/rocks with water just touching the base, blooms in 4–6 weeks; discard after bloom (standard practice). Can also be planted outdoors in fall in mild Bay Area gardens where it may naturalize, but the classic use is the temporary indoor display | ★★★★ Strong fragrance typical of the tazetta group (most other narcissus are scentless or weakly scented) | Feb–Mar | No traditional Asian cultural background for this Western tazetta form; the classic Chinese New Year narcissus is N. tazetta var. chinensis — do not confuse the two | | Hyacinth（Hyacinthus orientalis）



| 风信子 | Primarily an indoor forcing bulb (pre-chilled or chilled, then bloomed in soil or water; often discarded after). Can also be planted outdoors in fall (15 cm deep, good drainage, dry summer dormancy) and may persist as a garden bulb in mild Bay Area conditions, but the classic use is temporary indoor forcing | ★★★★★ 早春气味天花板；室内一瓶满屋 | 2–4 月 | 中东/地中海系，亚洲无传统；靠气味本身进入现代亚洲生活（切花/室内香） | | 'Brandywine' Crabapple（Malus 'Branzam' / Brandywine®）



| 海棠（'Brandywine'）[4] | 好种：小乔木，全日照，幼树给水，成熟耐旱；注意痂病（中等抗性）与锈病（较差） | ★★★★ 重瓣玫瑰粉色花，浓香；果实偏苦 | 3–4 月（花） | 海棠是经典"海棠四品"（贴梗/垂丝/西府/日本）的春天象征；'Brandywine' 是 1970s–80s Simpson Nursery 培育的重瓣粉色开花海棠，果实较大（约 1"）但偏苦/单宁高，无亚洲渊源。名字与著名的 Brandywine 番茄无关 | | Mexican Orange Blossom（Choisya ternata）



| 三叶橙花 | 极好种：加州/墨西哥原生，零维护，耐旱，全日照至半阴 | ★★★ 橙花（neroli 型）香，中等 | 3–4 月（偶有秋末返花） | 北美原生，亚洲文化无背景；因闻起来像橙花而被亚洲园圃接纳 | | Pink Jasmine（Jasminum polyanthum）



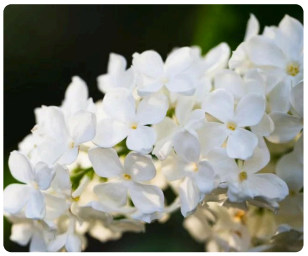
| 多花素馨（花市称"粉茉莉/多花茉莉"）[5] | 极好种：强健常绿藤，爱地中海气候，全日照，成型后耐旱；需要攀爬物 | ★★★★★ "茉莉族"里最香；粉色花苞开白，夏夜尤烈 | 3–10 月（春最盛） | 原产中国西南（滇黔），与茉莉花茶所用的 J. multiflorum 同属近缘；本身无深度文化典故 | | Chinese Wisteria（Wisteria sinensis）



| 紫藤 | 能种：日紫藤更香但雾区长不好，两难之下选本种；植株巨大，要钢架级支撑；幼树给水，成型耐旱；沿海有逸生记录，别放篱边 | ★★★ 淡甜香，远弱于日紫藤（W. floribunda） | 4–5 月（先花后叶或同步） | 唐宋以来诗词书画常客；日本有藤花祭（fuji）；韩国视紫藤为长寿/婚姻美满的象征 | | Perfumed Currant（Ribes odoratum）



| 香醋栗（香水醋栗） | 可种：北美中部原生（明尼苏达至德克萨斯一带，非太平洋沿岸），喜凉，全日照至半阴，成型后耐旱。Note: this white-flowered eastern form is a cold-climate shrub (USA 3–4) and is one of the harder plants in the table for the Bay Area — it survives Berkeley winters but needs consistent moisture and summer protection from dry heat/fog-free heat (a pot, a cool moist corner, or summer irrigation); the yellow-flowered California-native *R. aureum* (var. *gracillimum*) is the form that thrives here if scent can be traded for reliability. | ★★★★★ 茉莉+橙花/丁香型花香，浆果灌木里很香 | 5–6 月 | 北美中部原生，亚洲文化无背景；对亚洲园圃是"新移民" | | Lilac, white（Syringa vulgaris 白花系；海岸更稳：Syringa reticulata 香花丁香）



| 白丁香[6] | 中等：S. vulgaris 在湾区能活但偏水土不服（它爱更湿更凉的东部气候）——全日照+排水+夏补一点水；图省心选 S. reticulata，耐旱耐雾 | ★★★★ 白花品种通常比紫花更冲 | 5–6 月 | "丁香结"——花苞未展如结，李商隐"芭蕉不展丁香结"，中国诗词里幽郁愁思的经典意象（多指紫丁香）；日本视丁香为早春报春花 | | Gardenia（Gardenia jasminoides）



| 栀子花 | 好种名单里最难：酸性土（pH\<6）、持续湿润、补铁、防霜；雾带反给一点湿度；最稳方案是盆栽+冬季挪入 | ★★★★★ 白花朵朵满屋，单支即可充满一个房间 | 5–9 月（湾区盛于夏末） | "花中四雅"之一；果实是传统天然黄染料（栀子黄）与中药；流行文化里《栀子花开》= 青春/夏日符号；日本"くちなし"偏哀愁意象（墓地植栽传统） | | Cleveland Sage（Salvia clevelandii）



| 克利夫兰鼠尾草 | 极好种：加州原生，全日照，旱到不用管 | ★★★★ 风一过整丛出香，揉叶香气很冲 | 5–9 月（湾区含秋末返花） | 加州原生，无亚洲背景；可视为西方版"芳香鼠尾草"，功能位同亚洲的藿香/紫苏 | | California Mock Orange（Philadelphus lewisii）



| 山梅花（刘易斯山梅花） | 好种：太平洋西北原生，耐寒健壮，全日照，夏适量给水 | ★★★★ 花季"橙花/ mock orange"浓香 | 5–6 月 | 种名无亚洲背景；"山梅花"是 Philadelphus 属的中文正名，容易让人误以为有中式渊源 | | Damask Rose（Rosa × damascena）



| 大马士革玫瑰（大马士革蔷薇、突厥蔷薇） | 中难：雾带里挑**最晒、最干、排水最好**的位置；凉湿春秋防霜霉/白粉；雾会明显削弱出香[7] | ★★★★★ 玫瑰香基准（rose otto/纯露都出自它）；雾区夏凉会打折 | 5–6 月（单季） | 伊朗国花，沙特 Taif 玫瑰蒸馏技艺入联合国非遗；印度 gulab（玫瑰水/酱）的信仰与饮食基底；中国玫瑰饼/玫瑰月饼/玫瑰露酒传统 | | Rugosa Rose（Rosa rugosa，含平阴玫瑰 R. rugosa var. platyphylla）



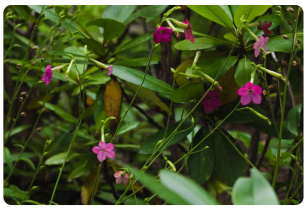
| 突瓣蔷薇/海滨蔷薇（平阴玫瑰系）[8] | 极好种：东亚海岸沙滩玫瑰，在加州海岸已归化；耐旱耐盐耐风，建植后不浇；根茎蔓延，控好边界 | ★★★ 中等（平阴宽叶型更香、更偏食用）；远弱于大马士革 | 6–8 月（可复花） | 平阴玫瑰（山东）是中国经典食用玫瑰：玫瑰酱/玫瑰饼/玫瑰露；rugosa 系是中国食用玫瑰的主力血统 | | Lavender（Lavandula angustifolia，'Hidcote'/'Sentia'/'Dunvegan'）



| 薰衣草 | 好种：真薰衣草完全适应湾区；全日照+排水极好的干地，成型后断水；雾区偏凉没问题，忌积水 | ★★★★★ 全株四季常香，花季最烈 | 6–8 月（品种错开） | 西方浪漫/普罗旺斯符号，亚洲无传统背景；随切花与香薰进入现代生活 | | Star Jasmine（Trachelospermum jasminoides）



| 络石（花市称"风车茉莉"，实非茉莉属） | 极好种：常绿藤，需要攀爬物，成型后耐旱，全日照至半阴 | ★★★★ 茉莉型浓香，傍晚最明显；湾区冬季可返花返香 | 7–9 月（湾区偶有冬季返花） | 络石藤是中国传统中药（祛风通络）；"风车茉莉"是纯商业名，本种无花文化典故 | | Flowering Tobacco（Nicotiana alata）



| 花烟草 | 极好种：夏播一年生，常自播成苗；喜热喜阳耐旱；全表唯一"夜间香"主力 | ★★★★★ 日落后开到浓烈，夏季花园的嗅觉天花板 | 7 月–霜降（香味集中在夜） | 新世界植物（烟草属北美/南美原产），亚洲无传统 | | Sweet Osmanthus (Osmanthus fragrans)



| 桂花 | Grows well but at a discount: hardy and thrives in the Bay Area, but the heavy fog and not-hot-enough summers mean fewer flowers and a blunted scent; plant in the sunniest, warmest corner possible; repeat-flowering types (佛顶珠 Fodingzhu / 四季桂 Sijigui) bloom more reliably here than 金桂 Jinguì[7] | ★★★★★ The benchmark of autumn scent (still the strongest autumn fragrance in the fog belt, discount applied) | Sept–Oct (Bay Area; Sept–Nov farther east or inland) | #1 in the table for cultural weight: the flower most tied to the Mid-Autumn Festival (桂花月饼 osmanthus mooncakes); 折桂 “picking osmanthus in the moon palace” = the millennial metaphor for passing the imperial exams (科举及第); osmanthus wine/cakes/tea; written through by Li Bai (李白), Lu You (陆游) and poets of every age since; in Japan one of the three great aromatic trees (三大香木), with daphne and gardenia; the same autumn/moon lineage on the Korean Peninsula (Chuseok □□) |

脚注 · Footnotes

[1] **Wintersweet — plant the yellow-flowered types**: white-flowered chimonanthus is generally faint; for real scent, grow the yellow-green-flowered types ('Aureus', 'Aureospiculata' / 苏雨仙 "Su Yuxian").

[2] **Wallflower 桂竹香** is the standard Chinese name for *Cheiranthus cheiri* (Brassicaceae, genus *Cheiranthus*) — unrelated to osmanthus 桂花 or bamboo 竹; the name is just an inherited old term. The English plant name cheiranth (from the genus name) likewise shares the same Greek root.

[3] **Paperwhite vs Chinese narcissus**: paperwhite belongs to the Western *tazetta* hybrid line; the traditional Chinese New Year flower is the Chinese narcissus (*N. tazetta* var. *chinensis*). Same genus, entirely different cultural systems.

[4] **海棠 "haitang" vs 'Brandywine'**: 海棠 in Chinese is a broad cultural term covering flowering crabapples/quince (贴梗 / 垂丝 / 西府 / 日本海棠); 'Brandywine' (botanical name *Malus* 'Branzam') is a double-petaled pink-flowering crabapple bred by Simpson Nursery in Indiana in the 1970s–80s, fruit ~1 inch, rather bitter. The name is a common place name, unrelated to the famous 19th-century Brandywine tomato (named for Brandywine Creek on the PA/DE border), and no kin to Chinese 海棠.

[5] **多花素馨 is not "true jasmine"**: jasmine tea is made mainly from *Jasminum sambac* (Arabian jasmine / 虎丘茉莉 Huqiu jasmine); *J. polyanthum* is a hardy vine native to southwestern China, sold as "粉茉莉/云南茉莉" (pink jasmine / Yunnan jasmine), with a stronger, more assertive scent.

[6] **The name "白丁香" (white lilac) is ambiguous**: Chinese "白丁香" usually means white-flowered cultivars of common lilac (*S. vulgaris*); but on the coast / in the Bay Area, the fragrant lilac *S. reticulata* (white, drought- and fog-tolerant) is the more dependable choice. Buy by botanical name: *S. vulgaris* = moderate difficulty, *S. reticulata* = easy.

[7] **The fog-belt penalty clause**: "dry-heat heavy-scent" plants like Damask rose and sweet osmanthus 桂花 all get their scent discounted in Berkeley's fog — this is not a growing-practice issue, it is a climate ceiling. For full-strength scent, choose inland hot valley floors (inland East Bay south of Oakland's east side, the Foothills) or accept pot culture.

[8] **The 平阴玫瑰 (Pingyin rose) line**: commercial "平阴玫瑰" = the broad-leaved variety of *Rosa rugosa* (var. *platyphylla*), the workhorse of northern China's edible roses (rose jam 玫瑰酱 / rose cakes 玫瑰饼); in the Bay Area grow it like an ordinary *R. rugosa* — its scent is pleasant but far weaker than Damask rose (the reference standard for rose perfumes and edible roses), matching the row's ★★★ rating.

Image credits

Flower photos resized from Wikimedia Commons (CC BY-SA / public domain) or open web sources. Full attribution and licenses are on the original Commons file pages.

- Wintersweet: *File:Chimonanthus praecox, Morris Arboretum 02.jpg* (Shuvaev, CC)
- Wallflower: *File:Erysimum cheiri gold garden flowers.jpg* (Jina Lee, CC BY-SA)
- White Champaca: *File:White champak flower.jpg* (SKsiddhartthan)
- Banana Shrub: *File:Michelia figo flower.JPG* (Midori, CC BY-SA)
- Winter Daphne: open web (Daphne odora in bloom)
- Paperwhite: *File:Narcissus papyraceus 'Paper-White Narcissus' (Amaryllidaceae) flowers HDR.jpg* (Magnus Manske)
- Hyacinth: open web (Hyacinthus orientalis in bloom)
- 'Brandywine' Crabapple: general double pink Malus blossom (proxy; specific cultivar photo scarce)
- Mexican Orange: *File:Choisya Inflorescence FR 2013.jpg* (JLPC, CC BY-SA)
- Pink Jasmine: *File:Jasminum polyanthum flowers.JPG* (B.navez)
- Chinese Wisteria: open web (Wisteria sinensis)
- Perfumed Currant: Dave's Garden member photo (re-hosted via Pinterest), cream/white-flowered form of clove currant. Note: standard botanical descriptions (FNA, MOBOT, RHS) list flowers as yellow; this photo is used per preference for the white/cream form. *R. odoratum* = *R. aureum* var. villosum.
- Lilac (white): open web (Syringa vulgaris white form)
- Gardenia: *File:Gardenia jasminoides flower.jpg* (Md Arif bd)
- Cleveland Sage: open web (Salvia clevelandii in bloom, lavender spikes)
- California Mock Orange: *File:Philadelphus lewisii (7283693140).jpg*
- Damask Rose: open web (Rosa × damascena)
- Rugosa Rose: open web (Rosa rugosa)
- Lavender: open web (Lavandula angustifolia)
- Star Jasmine: open web (Trachelospermum jasminoides)
- Flowering Tobacco: open web (Nicotiana alata)
- Sweet Osmanthus: open web (Osmanthus fragrans)